added to the juice or squash. When used in fruits with deep colours like blue grapes, jamun, watermelon it bleaches the colour and hence in such cases benzoic acid is desirable.

3. Organic acids and their salts:

Foods can be preserved by adding lactic, acetic, propionic, citric acids and their salts. Nitrates and nitrite compounds are used to preserve meat and fish products. It gives desirable colour, flavor and discourages the growth of micro-organisms. It also prevents toxin formation by the microorganisms in food.

6.3 Salting and Pickling

6.3.1 Salting

R71BCV

Salt is added to enhance taste and extend shelf life in foods such as butter, cheese, vegetables, bread and meat products. Dry salting is used for meat, mango, amla and fish.



▲ Plate 6.11 Sundried Mango



▲ Plate 6.12 Sundried Mor Milagai

6.3.2 Pickling

It is also an ancient preservation technique. The preservation of fruits and vegetables using common salt, vinegar, oil and spices are referred to as pickling. The layer of oil that floats on the top of pickles prevents the entry and growth of microorganisms like moulds and yeast. Spices like turmeric, pepper, chilli powder and asafoetida retard the growth of bacteria. Vinegar provides an unfavorable acidic environment for microbial growth. The salt added absorbs water and prevents the growth of micro-organisms.

Pickles are good appetizers. They add palatability to the meal. They help in digestion by stimulating the flow of gastric juices. The nutritive value of the pickles varies depending on the raw materials and methods of preparation adopted. Raw mangoes, lemon, amla, ginger, garlic,



▲ Plate 6.13 Mango pickle

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